The Map Beneath the Sunflowers

A Copper Tree story and colouring adventure



A story to share. A world to make your own.

Created by Emotive Impact

You are part of the adventure.

Meet six friends who live in Copper Tree. They ask questions, make things, make mistakes and help each other. There is room for you too.

Amara
An artist with wonderfully big ideas.

Kofi
An inventor who loves figuring things out.

Zuri
An explorer with a question for everything.

Eli
A playful friend who loves a good game.

Nia
A gardener who notices the little things.

Tayo
A dreamer who keeps looking up.

Read together or on your own. After every two story pages, there is a picture to colour. Use the drawing spaces for your own ideas. You can tell someone your answer instead of writing it.

Grown-ups: print at actual size on A4 paper. Single-sided printing is helpful for colouring. Try pencils or crayons first. Place scrap paper underneath if using felt-tip pens.

A glint in the soil

Saturday was garden day in Copper Tree. Nia watered the sunflowers. Eli collected empty pots. Amara, Kofi and Tayo helped Mrs Bennett tidy the path. Zuri was looking for beetles when something flashed beneath a leaf. “Treasure!” she cried. Mrs Bennett helped her lift a little tin from the loose soil. Its lid was tightly shut. It rattled. Definitely treasure.

Your turn

Draw a garden with something tiny Zuri might discover beneath a leaf.

A message from before

Inside were a photograph, a folded map and a note. “For whoever finds this: there is still one thing we never finished.” The photograph showed three children beside the old garden shed. On the map, a dotted line joined a bell, a book and a star. “A spaceship landing place,” whispered Tayo. “My mystery,” said Zuri, holding it close.

Your turn

Draw and decorate a treasure tin of your own. Add the things you would put inside.

COLOUR COPPER TREE / SCENE 1



The bell at the market

Mrs Bennett agreed to walk with them. At Saturday Market, Zuri spotted a stallholder’s bell. “First clue!” Kofi pointed to the photograph. “There’s something behind—” “Later!” said Zuri. She asked about the bell. The stallholder shook his head. “Bought it last Tuesday.” Zuri’s shoulders dropped. The map looked much older than that.

Your turn

Design a market stall selling three things you would love to find.

A mystery with room

They sat on a bench. Kofi had stopped pointing. Zuri looked at the map, then at her friends. “I didn’t let you finish,” she said. “Sorry. Will you show me?” Kofi smiled and turned the photograph round. Behind the children was a bell on the shed wall. “Our first clue was back in the garden!”

Your turn

Draw how Zuri feels before and after asking Kofi for help. What could her face show?

COLOUR COPPER TREE / SCENE 2



The book by the bell

Back at the garden, Nia found the bell beneath a climbing plant. Beside it, Amara spotted a painted book. “It matches the map!” Mrs Bennett laughed. “I painted that! We wanted a story corner here.” Zuri held out the photograph for her to see. Mrs Bennett peered closely. “Goodness! That’s me with my friends!”

Your turn

Draw climbing leaves around a painted symbol for your favourite activity.

The unfinished corner

“Why didn’t you finish?” asked Eli. “The roof leaked,” said Mrs Bennett. “We packed our things into that tin to keep them dry. Then my family moved. The tin vanished during a garden tidy-up.” She looked at the weeds. “The roof was repaired later. The story corner was forgotten.” “Until now,” said Nia.

Your turn

Draw the story corner as you imagine it. Include somewhere comfortable to sit.

COLOUR COPPER TREE / SCENE 3



Follow the little star

Eli studied the map. “The star is beside the door.” They found a faded star on a loose wooden sign, tucked behind a flowerpot. Underneath were the words STORY CORNER. Tayo grinned. “So the treasure is a place!” Zuri laid the map where everyone could see it. “What could we make here together?”

Your turn

Make a sign for a place you would share with friends. Add your own symbol.

Six different ideas

Amara wanted a mural. Kofi wanted a discovery shelf. Nia wanted flowers by the door. Eli suggested a games basket. Tayo asked for somewhere to look at the sky. Zuri wanted a big map. “And space for new friends,” she added. Mrs Bennett nodded. “Let’s ask the garden committee. A shared place needs a shared plan.”

Your turn

Draw one thing you would add to the friends’ shared place. Where would it fit?

COLOUR COPPER TREE / SCENE 4



Many helping hands

The committee said yes. Adults checked the shed and fixed its stiff door. Uncle Deji put up shelves. The children washed pots, sorted books and painted with Mrs Bennett. When Zuri tried to carry too many cushions, Eli caught the tumbling one. “Expedition rescued,” he announced. Zuri laughed. “Thank you, Chief Cushion Catcher.”

Your turn

Design three cushions with different patterns. Invent a funny helper title for yourself.

The Lookout

A week later, six mismatched seats waited inside. Amara’s mural curled around Kofi’s discovery shelf. Nia’s flowers stood outside. The games basket sat below a map with plenty of blank space. “We need a name,” said Tayo. “We look out for discoveries,” said Zuri. “And each other,” added Nia. “The Lookout!” they shouted.

Your turn

Design a tiny mural for the Lookout. Leave space for another person to add something.

COLOUR COPPER TREE / SCENE 5



Everyone brings something

At the opening, neighbours brought books, bunting and a plate of warm buns. Grandad Leon challenged Eli to a game. Mrs Bennett rang the old bell with its new rope. Zuri showed everyone the photograph. “We found their unfinished idea,” she said. “Then everyone helped it grow.” Tayo checked the sky. “Still room for a spaceship.”

Your turn

Draw yourself at the celebration. What would you bring to share?

For whoever comes next

The tin became the first treasure on the discovery shelf. Together, the friends wrote a new message: “There is room for your ideas here.” Zuri tucked it inside and left the lid open. Outside, the sunflowers nodded over the path. “What shall we discover next?” she asked. This time, she waited to hear everybody’s answer.

Your turn

Draw your next adventure. Who comes with you, and what might you discover?

COLOUR COPPER TREE / SCENE 6



A place for you

Draw yourself with the Copper Tree friends. Where would you meet? What would you bring to share?

What happens next?

Invent another adventure. Draw the first thing the friends discover. Give your adventure a name, or tell someone your story.